Devin Todd, PhD, PEng

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Motivation

I work for a better world at the intersections of R&D, industry, and governance. As a deep generalist, I build partnerships that drive innovation and create enduring outcomes. Equally at home in the shop, boardroom, or town hall, I am committed to leading initiatives grounded in integrity, transdisciplinarity, and coproduction.

Skills Summary

Lead
- More than fifteen years of leadership experience spanning research, start-up, and consulting capacities.
- Oversight of multimillion dollar large-scale initiatives and complex R&D portfolios.
- Management of flat and matrix teams encompassing diverse values, priorities, and expertise.
- Organizational growth through strategic planning, relationship building, and business development.

Innovate
- Broad engineering expertise spanning sustainability, cleantech, and design.
- Techno-economic modelling and project/technology assessment.
- Knowledge mobilization and communications product development for diverse audiences.

Build
- Design and prototyping using an array of software and CNC/manual tools.
- Automation, sensorics, and data acquisition integration across diverse hardware and frameworks.
- Data-driven, interactive insights using Excel, Matlab, Python, Jupyter, AI, and other tools.

Experience

Solid Carbon — **Victoria, BC**
Researcher & Alliance Manager — **Mar. 2020 – onwards**
- Manage a multinational carbon removal research partnership originally through PICS and now ONC.
- Oversee scope and transdisciplinary coordination across multiple teams and dozens of contributors spanning engineering, earth sciences, social sciences, policy, economics, history, and law.
- Administer its newest $24M flagship federal funding, building on >$3.5M prior grant and leveraged funds.
- Serve as ambassador for the partnership and its partners across diverse publics, governments, and sectors.
- Balance priorities from the strategic to the everyday through player-coach and servant leadership.
- Contribute to systems engineering research exploring system architectures and techno-economics.
- Co-develop public engagement workshops, inclusive of Env.-NGO and Indigenous community members.

Ocean Networks Canada (ONC) — **Victoria, BC**
Project Manager, Solid Carbon — **Jun. 2025 – onwards**
- Host Solid Carbon leadership and manage ONC contributions incl. marine ops and observatory expansion.
- Co-founded the BC/WA mCDR CoEx, a MEOPAR-funded initiative for regional marine carbon removal.
- Direct multiple project teams and other units/staff within a complex institutional and labour environment.
- Serve as a de facto lead for ONC's climate change strategic pillar. Represent interests on affiliates' boards.

Pacific Institute for Climate Solutions (PICS) — **Victoria, BC**
Researcher-in-Residence, Negative Emissions — **Mar. 2020 – Jun. 2024**
- Served as BC's expert on climate change mitigation, carbon removal, and net-zero GHGs.
- Provided trusted and strategic guidance to industry actors, policymakers, political executives, and more.
- Built relationships connecting solutions seekers and providers. Championed action through coproduction.
- Co-administered multimillion dollar, high-engagement grantmaking for high-impact climate research.
- Deployed knowledge mobilization tools: briefings, invited talks, events, radio, newspapers, reports, etc.
- Led development of the BC public service's new foundational climate action training.

New Leaf Management Ltd. **Vancouver, BC**
Mechanical Engineer and Technology Advisor **Apr. 2016 – Feb. 2020**
- Co-led mechanical design for novel kite power and vertical axis wind turbine systems.
- Led partnership proposals, including negotiating an R&D roadmap with kite power's then largest player.
- Led techno-economic analysis of New Leaf and competitors and advised on business strategy evolution.
- Managed intellectual property, including prior-art analyses, patent drafting, and counsel coordination.
- Provided technical advisory to New Leaf's executive and VC affiliates on other cleantech investments.
- Advised on sustainability, risks, and opportunities, while screening for economic returns and fatal flaws.

UBC Department of Mechanical Engineering **Vancouver, BC**
Graduate Student Researcher **Sep. 2010 – Feb. 2016**
- Explored novel hardware, methods and materials to improve fuel cell performance.
- Led the entire R&D process, including design, budgeting, implementation, and reporting.
- Supervised junior students and staff, as well as managed laboratory systems and infrastructure.
- Supported the formation and execution of the $4.9M UBC-Fraunhofer partnership in clean energy.

Formula SAE Team, UBC **Vancouver, BC**
Senior Member **Nov. 2006 – Aug. 2011**
- Designed and constructed an open-wheeled race car for the Formula SAE competition.
- Led the drivetrain group to success in a deadline driven project.

Robert Bosch GmbH – Corporate Sector Research **Gerlingen, Germany**
CR/ARY3 Praktikant **Jan. 2009 – Aug. 2009**
- Developed novel piezo sensors for critical-system applications in harsh environments.
- Designed experiments to validate (successfully) sensor reliability and precision.

Powertech Labs Inc. **Surrey, BC**
Energy Systems Co-op Education Student **May 2008 – Aug. 2008**
- Fabricated H_2 vehicle fuelling and research infrastructure.
- Coordinated between fabrication and engineering teams.

Cellula Robotics Ltd. **New Westminster, BC**
Engineering Data Analyst **Sep. 2007 – Dec. 2007**
- Developed a program to produce bathymetry of a subsea mining prospect.
- Fused submersible telemetry from multiple sensors (e.g. inertial, sonar, depth).

UBC Department of Mechanical Engineering **Vancouver, BC**
Undergraduate Research Assistant **May 2007 – Aug. 2007**
- Reconstructed 3D models of paper-forming fabrics using microtomy.
- Refined and standardized the methods.

Education

University of British Columbia **Vancouver, BC**
PhD Mechanical Engineering (leapfrogged MASc) **Feb. 2016**

University of British Columbia **Vancouver, BC**
BASc Mechanical Engineering with distinction (Thermofluids option, top graduate) **May 2010**

Awards and Recognitions

Four Year Doctoral Fellowship (UBC, $18,200/yr) **2013 – 2015**
NSERC PGS-D (Federal, $42,000) **2013**
NSERC CGS-M (Federal, $17,500) **2010**

Certifications

Engineers and Geoscientists British Columbia
Professional Engineer, #54617

Commercial Marine
SVOP, SDV-BS, ROC-M, Marine Basic First Aid